



Cambridge IGCSE™

FIRST LANGUAGE ENGLISH

0500/22

Paper 2 Directed Writing and Composition

October/November 2024

INSERT

2 hours

INFORMATION

- This insert contains the reading texts.
- You may annotate this insert and use the blank spaces for planning. **Do not write your answers** on the insert.



This document has 4 pages. Any blank pages are indicated.

Read **both** texts, and then answer **Question 1** on the question paper.

Text A: Teenage cooks: a minority?

The following passage is an article by a well-known restaurant critic.

'Within a generation we'll have forgotten how to cook,' warns celebrity chef, Jimmy Marron. His solution? His website offers 30 recipes, encouraging the youth of today to learn these 'basic cooking skills'.

'Cooking's fun and rewarding,' says Marron, who knows a bit about the rewards from cooking, having bought himself a collection of classic cars on the proceeds. 'You just need to get started.' 5

Is he right? About the forgetting how to cook I mean – and his additional claim that no one under 25 cooks anymore. Have our attitudes to cooking changed that much? Well, obviously in my time every teenager cooked wholesome broths to take to their sick grannies and absolutely nobody ate instant noodles or takeaway pizza!

Admittedly, I was encouraged to cook when I was a kid. We had 'domestic science' lessons at school, so from time to time I tortured my family with imaginative, if undercooked, concoctions warmed in a microwave, but these weren't real cooking skills. At university, living away from home, I was still mangling ingredients. I remember trying unsuccessfully to cook a fancy meal to impress a girlfriend. In my late 20s, I set up home with my wife and really started to learn how to cook. I bought books. I slaved away in the kitchen, in the way you do when you want to create a sense of domestic bliss. 10 15

Nowadays, in our house, our 13-year-old son must do chores each week – it gets him off the internet. Perhaps unsurprisingly, given what I do for a living, the one he chooses most regularly is preparing the family meal, under guidance from one of us. He's surprisingly good.

So, what have we learned? Well, not very much really. A study of 80000 cookery book buyers recently reported that nearly half of them cooked once a week or more. Statistically, some of them must be young? And anecdotally I can say that all people ever want to talk to me about is cooking. So, the appetite is there for it. 20

Perhaps technology can be blamed (it usually can). Kids are spending too much time online to be interested in cooking. Though my suspicion is that people are heading back towards the kitchen because it's cheaper than the alternatives. 25

Text B: I don't want to cook for my family, and I'm tired of feeling guilty about it

In the passage below, the writer describes visiting a friend's house for a meal.

'Try this,' Lawrence said, offering me one of his creations – an artisan cracker stacked with goat cheese, topped with fresh herbs picked from his garden.

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excellent at that.

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2 hours

You must answer on the question paper.

You will need: Insert (enclosed)

INSTRUCTIONS

- Answer **two** questions in total:
Section A: answer Question 1.
Section B: answer **one** question.
- Use a black or dark blue pen.
- Write your name, centre number and candidate number in the boxes at the top of the page.
- Write your answer to each question in the space provided.
- Do **not** use an erasable pen or correction fluid.
- Do **not** write on any bar codes.
- If additional space is needed, you should use the lined pages at the end of this booklet; the question number or numbers must be clearly shown.
- Dictionaries are **not** allowed.

INFORMATION

- The total mark for this paper is 80.
- The number of marks for each question or part question is shown in brackets [].
- The insert contains the reading texts.

This document has **12** pages. Any blank pages are indicated.



Read Text A and Text B in the insert and then answer **Section A, Question 1** on this question paper.

Section A: Directed writing

Question 1

Write an **article** for a teenage magazine with the title, 'What's the point of learning to cook?'

In your article you should:

- evaluate the ideas, attitudes and opinions given in both texts
- give your views on whether or not young people need to cook and want to cook.

Base your article on what you have read in **both** texts but be careful to use your own words. Address both of the bullet points.

Write about 250 to 350 words.

Up to 15 marks are available for the content of your answer and up to 25 marks for the quality of your writing.

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DO NOT WRITE IN THIS MARGIN

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[Turn to page 6 for Section B.]



**Section B: Composition**

Answer **one** question from Section B.

Write about 350 to 450 words on **one** of the following questions. Answer on this question paper.

Up to 16 marks are available for the content and structure of your answer and up to 24 marks for the style and accuracy of your writing.

EITHER**Descriptive writing**

2 Describe a busy road before and after it rains.

OR**Descriptive writing**

3 Describe moving something heavy.

OR**Narrative writing**

4 Write a story including the words '... I saw the light ...'.

OR**Narrative writing**

5 Write a story with the title, 'The island'.



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